Television Addiction - How to Avoid It

Keep a record of how much TV you watch and when you watch. Do this for one week.

◆ List all the other fun activities you can do at home instead of watching TV. Place your list on your refrigerator so you can check this list BEFORE you turn on the TV.

◆ Set a limit for how much TV you will watch in one week. Record your time and stick to your commitment.

◆ Consider removing your TV for a set period of time. You might find yourself talking to your family again instead of watching the TV so much.

Below are some signs that you're probably addicted to TV or a screen-based gadget like video games or mobile phones.

1. You live for the next episode of your favourite TV serial. If you find yourself wondering or feeling anxious through the week about what is going to happen next make sure you fill up your time with active, non-TV related things. Enjoy your characters and your plots, but don't let it eat you up throughout the week. Or if you want to check your Whatsapp or Facebook constantly, it is time to talk face to face with friends and family.

3. You would rather cancel an outing with family or friends than miss your serial. Staying at home can sometimes be very relaxing. We do not want to rush about all the time. But if your favourite serial starts becoming more important than being with friends, doing homework or talking to your family, then you may want to think again when you hit the power button on the remote.

4. If you switch on the TV or phone as soon as you get up because you cannot bear the silence or cannot wait to know if someone has texted you. Or you fall asleep with the TV chatter on, it is a sign of addiction. It is better to start your day with some calming silence instead of TV or texting chatter.

5. Many of us use TV or a virtual life on Facebook as a way to cover up depression, loneliness or just procrastination. After all it is much easier to sit on a sofa and watch someone else's trials and tribulations rather than face your own. Or it is a good distraction to keep up with Facebook friends rather than face your own problems, however, it would be better to work out what is bothering you and get help instead of drowning it all out with constant noise or TV chatter. It is good to balance TV watching with activities like reading, playing and enjoying indoor and outdoor hobbies. Remember that TV or the Internet is not life.

6. You may stay up late viewing a small screen and lose out on sleep. Watching TV or playing games just before you sleep is not good for you. Instead of calming you down, the stimulation and the glow of the screen can actually keep you awake. So, if you want to get some proper rest, turn everything off an hour before bed, and get some real sleep in the dark.

There's nothing wrong with watching TV or using social media but it should not control our life.

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